Teaching Statement

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Teaching Philosophy

My teaching is guided by a simple goal: to help students understand both the "why" behind empirical methods and the "how" required to implement them rigorously. Applied economics is most effective when students can connect economic intuition, identification strategies, and hands-on data work. I aim to train students to think critically about assumptions, to evaluate empirical claims, and to execute credible research designs.

I teach by combining clear exposition, policy-relevant examples, and replication of empirical papers using modern datasets. My own research, which lies at the intersection of reduced-form causal inference and empirically grounded econometric modeling, shapes this dual emphasis on intuition and implementation.

Teaching Experience

I served as Teaching Assistant for *Applied Econometrics and Statistical Learning for Economics* (graduate level) at HEC Montréal. The course was taught to a cohort of nine master's students. I led weekly tutorial sessions, supervised statistical software work, graded empirical assignments, held office hours, and advised students on their econometric projects. Students often sought guidance in translating economic questions into estimable models, and one student continued meeting with me after the course to discuss GMM estimation for panel data. This experience strengthened my belief that students learn best when theory, identification, and coding are taught as complementary tools.

I also have experience teaching technical material to professional audiences. In 2025, I was an instructor for a week-long Commitment to Equity (CEQ) fiscal incidence training in Senegal, teaching civil servants from multiple ministries. I am currently collaborating with the World Bank to develop a MOOC on fiscal incidence analysis. These experiences reinforced my ability to teach complex quantitative ideas to diverse groups and to design materials that build intuition step by step.

Courses I Am Prepared to Teach

Based on my training and research fields, I am prepared to teach the following courses at the undergraduate and graduate levels:

- Applied Econometrics
- Labor Economics
- Causal Inference and Empirical Strategies

- Applied Microeconometrics
- Development Economics

My experience working with Canadian administrative data and large international microdata also prepares me to supervise empirical theses and guide students working with complex datasets.

Teaching Approach and Classroom Environment

Students enter with different levels of preparation in mathematics, statistics, and coding. I therefore structure my teaching around:

- building intuition from first principles;
- using concrete, policy-relevant examples;
- emphasizing assumptions, not formulas;
- practicing with real datasets rather than artificial examples;
- evaluating reasoning rather than memorization.

I have worked with students from Canada, Sub-Saharan Africa, North Africa, etc. My own educational background in Côte d'Ivoire, in a fully French system, sensitizes me to different learning environments. I strive to create a classroom where students feel supported regardless of prior exposure to empirical methods.

Integration with Research and Mentoring

My research focuses on how institutional and market frictions shape access to high-return opportunities. This naturally feeds into teaching. I bring examples from Canadian labor markets, developing-country settings, and empirical papers from leading journals. I emphasize both how to implement methods and how to think critically about identification.

I am committed to advising empirical theses, especially those using administrative data, household surveys, or large labor datasets. My goal is to help students design credible empirical strategies and develop strong applied research skills.

Conclusion

I aim to contribute to your department's teaching mission by offering rigorous, data-driven applied courses and by helping students learn to use empirical methods thoughtfully and confidently. My experience teaching at both academic and professional levels has equipped me to engage diverse learners and to mentor students working with real-world data.